



War over oil is not such a far-fetched idea. It might even be inevitable

Uncle Ben wasn't wrong when he uttered those famous words, "With great power comes great responsibility."

The inner workings of this blame game are very simple. Say a country like the USA is claiming to have reduced its CO₂ emissions by a factor of X. That reduction may be because it has reduced the

burning of fossil fuels, but not because it has reduced its consumption of power. Outsourcing production of something like the iPhone or Samsung Galaxy phones will have shifted to a country like China or Vietnam, which will burn up a huge amount of resources to produce those said goods. Now suddenly China is the villain, it's producing billions of tonnes of CO₂ and contributing to global warming while the US takes a "holier than thou" stand claiming to be working hard to reduce its emissions while irresponsible governments remain hell-bent on wrecking the Earth's environment, without ever taking into consideration that they are the largest market for said products. Pointing fingers is just not going to solve this crisis.

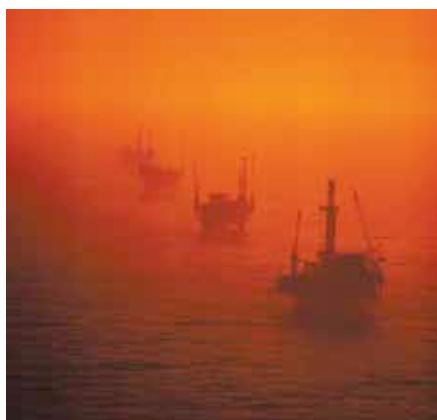
Another example would be Europe. Countries like Germany and Britain are at the forefront of the "green race" and are making huge strides in the advancements in green tech and are claiming to make a

difference in the world. The reality is that they are simply running out of coal and oil reserves and desperately need power to stay relevant in the world. If they had larger reserves, they probably wouldn't even be considering green power. On the other hand, a country like Switzerland has built its power infrastructure on natural sources from the ground up (<http://dgit.in/10jq1Wc>). However, they're lucky because they're small and don't need so much power and the natural sources they have are sufficient for their needs.

Freedom to create or destroy

Oil (and fossil fuels) has, by itself, given us an immense degree of freedom and comfort at a level that was simply unimaginable even 200 years ago. Unfortunately, that freedom comes at a price and we're somehow finding a way to ignore that price; either by burying our head in the sand, not wanting to face reality or just expecting our governments to do something about it. It's our own intense degree of short-sightedness that is ruining our environment and it's high time we did something about it.

If we continue to burn up fossil fuels at the rate we are now, global temperatures will rise and we will start to destroy our environment. As a consequence of this, we will in fact increase our dependence on oil as we will simply require an even larger quantity of energy. Why? What do you do in summer these days? As the days grow warmer you just turn up your air-conditioners, generating more heat, using up more power and generating even more CO₂. This is a vicious cycle and there can be no end to this unless we stop, right now, and put in a conscious, global effort to reduce our power consumption. **d**



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